

Yijin Fang

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China

✉ fangyj22@mails.tsinghua.edu.cn

Education

Department of Psychological and Cognitive Sciences, Tsinghua University

Beijing, China

PhD candidate in Psychology

2022 - 2026 (expected)

- Advisor: Dr. Stella Christie
- Research focus: curiosity, exploration, and learning

Department of Psychology, University of California, Berkeley

Berkeley, CA, US

Visiting scholar in KiddLab

2026.08-2026.12

- Advisor: Dr. Celeste Kidd

Department of Psychological and Cognitive Sciences, Tsinghua University

Beijing, China

Enrolled in the MA program in Psychology

2019 - 2022

- Advisor: Dr. Stella Christie
- Completed masters requirements before transitioning to the PhD program

Fujian Medical University

Fujian, China

BS in Applied Psychology, specializing in clinical psychology

2014 - 2018

Publications

Published

Fang, Y., Christie, S. (in prep). Knowing less, exploring more? The role of metacognitive regulation in shaping explore-exploit decisions

Fang, Y., Yang, H.A., Christie, S. (in prep). Explore-exploit decisions between rural and urban children in middle childhood.

Fang, Y., Yang, H.A., Christie, S. (2025). Early experiences shape children's explore-exploit decisions: Evidence from the rural-urban gap. In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Fang, Y., Yang, H., Christie, S. (2024). The Effect of Perceived vs. Factual Knowledge on Exploration. In *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Lyu, J., **Fang, Y.**, Fan, W., Yang, H., Christie, S. (2022). 早期玩耍是终身学习的基础 [Early play serves as a foundation for lifelong learning]. *[Early Child Development]*. 1, 9-23.

Christie, S., Lyu, J., **Fang, Y.**, Han, X. (2020). The Cognitive Science of Designing Urban Spaces for Children. *Landscape Architecture Frontiers*. 2(8), 84-99.

Presentations & Posters

Conference Presentations

Fang, Y., Christie, S. (2025). The drive for knowledge in shaping explore-exploit decisions: The role of perception and self-monitoring. Oral presentation: Tsinghua Laboratory of Brain and Intelligence Seminar Series (THBI-SS) on Mar.14th, Beijing, China.

Fang, Y., Christie, S. (2023). Explore or exploit? The impact of knowledge on exploration behaviors. Oral presentation: Tsinghua Laboratory of Brain and Intelligence Seminar Series (THBI-SS) on Dec.7th, Beijing, China.

Fang, Y.*, Lyu, J.*, Christie, S. (2021). Learning from play: The mechanisms and constraints. Oral presentation: the 14th International Conference on Brain Informatics, Padova, Italy.

Conference Posters

Fang, Y., Yang, H.A., Christie, S. (2025). Early experiences in shaping children’s explore-exploit decisions: evidence from the rural-urban gap. Poster: the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco, USA.

Fang, Y., Yang, H., Christie, S. (2024). The Effect of Perceived vs. Factual Knowledge on Exploration. Poster: the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, the Netherlands.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2025	Graduate Student short-term visiting scholarship, Tsinghua University	\$ 6500
2024	Graduate Division Conference Travel Grant, Tsinghua University	\$ 1500
2023	“Future Social Designer” Research Grant, Tsinghua University	\$ 1500

Additional Research Experience

Cross-cultural differences in parental attitude towards play and learning *Beijing, China*
led by Dr. Hirsh-Pasek Kathy’s team *Sep 2020 –Aug 2022*

- Research focus: Differences in parental attitudes toward children’s play and learning. Cultural influences on these parental attitudes.

Children’s learning from free play *Beijing, China*
Collaborator: Jinyun Lyu, advised by Dr. Stella Christie *Sep 2019 –Aug 2022*

- Research focus: Learning mechanisms of free play. Cultural influences on children’s learning through play.

Teaching Experience

Spring 2024,
Fall 2022, Introduction to Psychology, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2021
Spring 2022 Introduction to Cognitive Science, Teaching Assistant

Community Service

Theoretical and Computational Neuroscience Summer School

Beijing, China

Volunteers leader

Summer 2024

Public Welfare Project – Caring for Migrant Children

Beijing, China

Volunteer

Fall 2023

Social Practice Project – Caring for Left-behind Children

Hubei, China

Volunteer & organizer

Summer 2023